HOUSING STANDARDS & INSPECTION CHECKLIST
PEACE CORPS COLOMBIA

PCV Name:	Site:
Type here.	Type here.
Project	Date:
	Click here to enter a date.
Name of Staff Member to Complete Form:	# of House Check:
Type here.	Choose an item.

CONTACT INFORMATION				
House address:	Type here.			
House phone number (if available):	Type here.			
Names of heads of household or Landlord/s:	Name :	Type here.	Phone:	Type here.
	Name:	Type here.	Phone:	Type here.

	GPS Longitude (Decimal Degrees)	GPS Latitude (Decimal Degrees)	Elevation
House	Type here.	Type here.	Type here.
Work Site 1	Type here.	Type here.	Type here.
Work Site 2	Type here.	Type here.	Type here.

The following are minimum standards for all host family stays regardless of the duration.

	URBAN ☐	RURAL ☐	Meets ✓	Comments
LOCATION	No more than 30m (100ft) from nearest visible neighbor.	Must be visible from street or walking path and no more than 50m (160ft) from nearest occupied house.	☐	Type here.
	Interviews with community members and/or police suggest area has a relatively low crime rate and is not near dangerous or high risk areas (e.g., bars, bus stations, etc.).		☐	Type here.
	House has not been recently burglarized OR improvements have been made to avoid future burglaries.		☐	Type here.
TYPE OF HOUSE	Must be made of cement block, concrete, bricks or solid wood walls. The house must be free of visible structural damage, spaces between wood boards or entry points for burglars.	Must be made of cement block, concrete, bricks, solid wood, or solid adobe. The house must be free of visible structural damage, spaces between wood boards or entry points for burglars.	☐	Type here.
	No sheet metal houses. No thatch houses. No adobe houses.	If house is made of adobe, it must have a smooth surface and no visible cracks that indicate structural damage.	☐	
	If the house has open areas or patios it is preferable to have a fence with a lock.	In some rural communities, thatch or sheet metal may be the only available material. In such cases, Post should carefully consider the local norms and the local crime environment before approval.	☐	
	If electricity is available, open areas should be capable of illumination at night.		☐	Type here.

KITCHEN	The cooking area of the house is clear of unnecessary flammable material and is adequately ventilated for safety. Adequate ventilation means there are two air intakes within the home (e.g. two windows, a door and a window, two doors, etc.) that creates a cross breeze.	☐	Type here.
	b. There is adequate ventilation within the home for cooking and there is sufficient space to allow the tank to be placed at least 1.5 meters from the stove (means longer hoses and a prohibition on the use of tank-top stoves). *If neither a nor b is possible, Volunteer must be trained in conducting monthly safety tests on gas tank.	☐	
	If wood is used as a cooking fuel, fire smoke has a chimney to outside the kitchen area or there is adequate ventilation.	☐	
	The cooking area of the house is free of pests (such as rodents) or other animals (such as guinea pigs, chickens, or household pets).	☐	Type here.
	There is a method of extinguishing a fire available (e.g. a fire extinguisher or a bucket of sand) in the kitchen area.	☐	Type here.

DOORS	Doors with outside access must be made of solid wood or metal and there must be a secure locking mechanism in place to lock from the outside and the inside. Doors with outside access must have an inside lock that cannot be reached through a nearby window, unless the window has a heavy metal security screen.		☑	Type here.
	Sliding bolt locks in upper and lower corners or wooden/metal bars are required for outside doors.	Sliding bolt locks in upper and lower corners or wooden/metal bars are preferred for outside doors.	☑	Type here.
WINDOWS	All house windows must have burglar bars, heavy metal security screens or have frames made of solid metal. Any windows with glass panes or openings larger than 25 centimeters (10 inches) must have burglar bars or heavy metal security screen. Windows that open must have a secure locking mechanism on the inside.	All house windows must have burglar bars, or local equivalent or be made of solid metal or solid wood frames. Any glass pane or opening larger than 25 centimeters (10 inches) must have burglar bars, heavy metal security screens or local equivalent. Windows that open must have a secure locking mechanism on the inside.	☐	Type here.
ROOF	Support beams must be made of metal or solid wood without signs of rot.		☐	
	The maximum space between the top of the house's exterior walls and the roof must not be greater than 15 centimeters (6 inches).		☐	
	Roof must be made of a solid material, such as tin or clay tiles in good condition.	Roof must be made of a solid material, such as tin or clay tiles in good condition. Thatch roofs may be acceptable if the only available material and appropriate to local norms and security.	☐	Type here.
ELECTRIC	If electricity is present, wiring appears to be in good condition with no visible breaks, burns, melts or naked wiring. Electrical outlets and switches are in working condition. In urban areas the house should have a formal electrical meter.	If electricity is present, wiring appears to be in good condition with no visible breaks, burns, melts or naked wiring. Electrical outlets and switches are in working condition.	☐	Type here.

WATER – SANITATION	Latrine or toilet and bathing area must be within 10m (33ft) from house.	✔	
	If there is a latrine, it must be of sturdy construction (not of plastic sheeting or cloth) and meet basic hygiene standards. The latrine must be relatively clean, not full, and free of pests. The latrine should not fill up in the rainy season.	☐	Type here.
	When latrine and bathing areas are separate from the house they must have mechanisms on the inside to secure the door and must provide adequate cover and privacy.	☐	Type here.
	House must have year round accessibility to a treatable water source. If water shortages are normal, house must have proper storage tanks/barrels for emergency use.	☐	Type here.
NATURAL DISASTERS	House is not on a flood plain or within 50m (160ft) from cliff edges or bases of hills.	☐	Type here.

HOUSE IS APPROVED ☐ HOUSE IS NOT APPROVED ☐

Actions Required Before Approval:	**By whom?**	**Due Date**
Type here.	Type here.	
Type here.	Type here.	
Type here.	Type here.	

Follow up actions when house is approved:

☐ Staff member completes and signs Housing Checklist

☐ SSM reviews and signs Housing Checklist

☐ Housing criteria is monitored and tracked through staff site visits

☐ Housing approval and checklist included in Site History Files

NOTE: This inspection tool must be completed by PC Colombia prior to PCV occupancy.

Every item has to be in compliance.

The house cannot be approved until all requirements are met.

Staff member who filled out the form

Host family coordinator

SSM

PCMO

USDH

Any changes to this form must be approved by the Region's RSA in consultation with the PCSSO